# Mathieu Lindemann

## Software Engineering Leader · Entrepreneur

I have 20 years of experience leading tech teams in startups and large companies.
My impact scales through the great individuals and organizations I develop.
I started, scaled and turned over distributed teams in the EU, APAC and the U.S.
I built and led organizations with 70+ engineers, improved systems serving billions of daily users and delivered annual recurring revenues over $200m.

m@lindemann.co · +41.78.208.30.28 · Lausanne · /in/mlindemann · /mathieu_lindemann

## GOALS

I am passionate about engineering excellence, making it look simple thanks to meaningful individual and collective goals and nudges.

I deeply care about developing great engineers and managers, rooting quality, adaptability and transparency deep in the culture.

I lead by example, holding myself and the whole tech organization accountable, reliable, supportive and accessible to other functions.

I am industry-agnostic. I enjoyed working in real estate, payments, ad-tech, cloud and web search. People and culture trump tech- and industry-specific limitations.

## SKILLS

## TECH

Back/Front
ML, AI
Scalability
CI/CD
SRE
Lean, Agile

## WORK EXPERIENCE

May 2023 – Jan 2021
**Software Engineering Manager**
Google Search · Zürich, Switzerland
Led a strategic effort of 20+ engineers in 5 time zones to identify authors of web pages, such as news articles and social posts, among the top 100bn web pages.
**Built the long term vision** with technical and non-technical stakeholders.
**Set a culture of engineering excellence**, improving e.g. data sourcing, prod monitoring.
**Led key cross-functional efforts**, e.g. impact on Search ranking, webmasters outreach.
Member of the **promotion committee** and **engineering velocity** steering committee.

Dec 2020 – May 2020
**SRE Manager**
Google Cloud AI · Zürich, Switzerland
Manager of the Zurich-based SRE team and mentor of the manager of the sister team in Pittsburgh, USA. These teams support Google Cloud AI products, 9-digit annual contract value and clients ranging from startups to Dow Jones-listed companies.
Got VP approval on **2 year plan** and **50% headcount growth** to support more services.
**Reduced the alerts reaching the teams** by 40% at no cost on client satisfaction.
Authored **2 guides on remote onboarding and people management**. Both became Google-wide official SRE material, reaching 3,000+ engineers.

Apr 2020 – Jan 2018
**Co-founder, CTO & COO**
Dili (Pinault Group) · Paris, France
Inspired by OpenDoor.com, Dili offered a hassle-free home selling experience in France.
**Deployed** the service to home sellers in France's 10 largest metropolitan areas.
**Bootstrapped** the tech and non-tech orgs (ops, marketing, sales, etc.), using the resources of Pinault real estate holding, **from 0 to positive EBITDA**.

Jan 2018 – Feb 2016
**Engineering Program Manager**
Criteo · Paris, France
Drove strategic-level R&D initiatives, leading 3 teams in machine learning (30+ FTE).
**Reorganized** the team in charge of core pricing models, **bringing +9% ARR (>180m€)** vs targeted +6% and **coaching a first-time manager** into a confident leader along the way.
**Turned around** an ML infra team, leading to fewer timeouts and **+1.6% ARR (>30m€)**.

Jan 2016 – Apr 2014
**CTO & General Manager for Vietnam**
helloPay | Rocket Internet · Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
helloPay was Rocket Internet's e-payment startup for Asia and a spinoff of Lazada.
**Bootstrapped** the tech org and systems from 0 to our acquisition by Alibaba/Alipay.
Grew the tech offices **from scratch to 70+ engineers** in Singapore and Ho Chi Minh City.
**Represented helloPay technical interests** in regulator audits and PCI DSS 1 application.

Apr 2014 – Apr 2012
**Head of Software Development**
Bouygues · Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
**Designed and led a 2-year performance improvement plan** to regain trust from HQ.
**Dropped** non-strategic activities to **focus** on high-value projects.
**Simplified** the processes, replacing meaningless routines with lean practices.
Implemented **career management** to develop leaders and high potential employees.
Results: rework decreased by 40%. The office still exists as of May 2023.

Work experience from 2004 to 2012 is visible on **LinkedIn**.

## STRENGTHS

Reliable · Autonomous · Transparent · Accountable · Team player · Focused
Pragmatic · Adaptable · Customer-centric · Cross-functional · Open to criticism

## LANGUAGES

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|---|---|
| English | Fluent |
| French | Mother tongue |
| Italian | Working proficiency |
| Spanish | Notions (eager to practice) |
| Vietnamese | Notions (eager to practice) |

## PHILOSOPHY

Here are some thoughts that guide my actions as a colleague and as a manager.

> *Success is a few simple disciplines, practiced every day; while failure is simply a few errors in judgment, repeated every day.*
> – **Jim Rohn**

> *With most subjects, it is more important to really understand the basic material than have exposure to more advanced concepts.*
> – **S. S. Skiena**

> *Besides the noble art of getting things done, there is the noble art of leaving things undone. The wisdom of life consists in the elimination of non-essentials.*
> – **Lin Yutang**

> *The people that really create the things that change this industry are both the thinker and doer in one person. [...] It's very easy to say "I thought of this three years ago". But usually when you dig a little deeper, you find that the people that really did it were also the people that really worked through the hard intellectual problems as well.*
> – **Steve Jobs**

## FORMAL EDUCATION

Jul 2004
Sep 2001

**Ingénieur des Mines**
M.Sc. · École des Mines de Paris · Paris, France
Mines ParisTech is one of the world's best universities, **ranked 31st globally** by the NY Times. **Major: Engineering Design & Management**, i.e. how to lead engineering teams to game-changing innovation.

## SELF-EDUCATION

Oct 2017

**Neural Networks and Deep Learning**
DeepLearning.ai via Coursera
This class covered the key DL methods used in 2017, such as CNN or LSTM. It required to implement them from scratch using **GNU Octave** to understand their strengths and limitations in detail.
Results: **Statement of Accomplishment**.

Dec 2013

**Introduction to Operations Management**
Wharton via Coursera
This online class covered practical concepts of operations management such as takt time or debottlenecking, and powerful frameworks like the Toyota Production System.
Results: **Statement of Accomplishment with distinction**.
I was also invited to TA the following iterations of the course and, ultimately, to proofread the draft of the next edition of Pr. Terwiesch's book ***"Matching Supply with Demand, an introduction to Operations Management"*** (ISBN: 978-1260084610).

Oct 2013

**CS191x: Quantum Mechanics and Quantum Computation**
Berkeley via edX
This online class was taught by Pr. Umesh Vazirani. It covered theoretical concepts of quantum physics (e.g. superposition of states, entanglement of particles) as well as practical implementations of quantum algorithms such as Shor's algorithm to factor large numbers.
Results: **Statement of Accomplishment**.

## PATENTS

Oct 2017

**Predictive adjusted bidding for electronic advertisements**
Criteo · Paris, France
I participated in the design of patent **#US11120481B2** while leading a long-shot project to detect auction mechanisms, from pure first-price to pure second-price with many variations in between. The stake was to optimize Criteo bidding strategy accordingly and secure the company's margin.

## MENTORING

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|---|---|
| Since 2016 | One ex-report engineering manager from Criteo who now works at Google. |
| Since 2018 | One ex-report data engineer from Dili who became manager at H&M. |
| Since 2022 | One backend engineer at Android, as part of Google mentoring program. |

## REFERENCES

My references are available upon request. Among others, they include:

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|---|---|
| Managers | A former CTO at Criteo and senior director at Google. |
| Reports | The VP of engineering at the fastest growing startup in the Middle East, whom I mentored at helloPay. |